

UPDATE:



Appendix G

Definitions & Acronyms

APPENDIX G –Definitions & Acronyms

Table of Contents

Definitions	G-2
Acronyms.....	G-5

Definitions

Air Quality Significant — projects that have the potential to impact air quality by affecting transportation-related air pollution through changes in traffic patterns or volumes. These are typically projects that include a component of project categories R4, R5, or T3, but a thorough evaluation is conducted as part of the annual air quality conformity determination. See *Air Quality Conformity Determination* (www.dvrpc.org/airquality/conformity/).

Congestion Management Process (CMP) — a systematic and regionally coordinated approach used to monitor, evaluate, and manage traffic congestion. The CMP identifies congested locations in the region and strategies to improve transportation system performance and safety through non-capacity-increasing alternatives such as operational improvements, demand management, and multimodal solutions. It is required in metropolitan areas to ensure that investment decisions consider congestion impacts and appropriate mitigation strategies.

Federalized (TIP) — any project that has obligated federal funds via the current or a previous Transportation Improvement Program

Federal Fiscal Year (FFY) — a 12-month period used by the federal government for budgeting and financial reporting purposes, beginning on October 1 and ending on September 30 of the following calendar year. For example, FFY 2026 runs from October 1, 2025, through September 30, 2026. This timeframe is used to track federal funding, including transportation

investments, and aligns with federal appropriations and grant cycles. DVRPC's Fiscal Year (FY) begins on July 1 and ends on June 30 of the following calendar year. For example, DVRPC FY 2026 denotes the 12-month period from July 1, 2025, to June 30, 2026.

Fiscal Constraint — the requirement that revenues in the transportation plan and TIP must be reasonably expected to be available and sufficient to cover the costs of the projects and programs included.

Long-Range Plan (LRP) — a comprehensive, fiscally constrained strategy that provides for the orderly growth and development of the region it serves and guides investments in the multimodal transportation system over at least a 20-year horizon. The Plan is required to be updated every four years in areas that do not meet federal air quality standards.

Lowest Life-Cycle Cost (LLCC) — Life-cycle planning is the process of estimating the total cost of managing an asset class or asset sub-group over its entire service life, with consideration for minimizing costs while preserving or improving asset condition (FHWA Asset Management Rule, 23 CFR 515.5). LLCC is an asset management strategy that seeks to maximize the service life of an asset at the lowest total cost through risk-based prioritization of preservation, rehabilitation, and reconstruction activities.

Major Regional Project (MRP) — large-scale projects (over \$40M) that are discrete projects with defined start and end dates, and not part of an ongoing program.

Metropolitan Planning Organization (MPO) — a federally mandated and federally funded transportation policy-making organization that is made up of representatives from local government and governmental transportation authorities.

Minor Regional Roadway Network Expansion Project — Roadway Network Expansion projects below the \$40M threshold that are funded via the TIP. These projects don't rise to the level of an MRP, but are still tracked in the Plan to account for all roadway system expansion projects region-wide in the 4 percent cap on regional spending. These projects are checked for consistency with the CMP and included in air quality conformity analysis.

Plan Elements — the key focus areas that structure the Long-Range Plan's Vision. *Update: Connections 2050* is organized around five core components: (1) Transportation, (2) Economy, (3) Communities, (4) Environment, and (5) Infrastructure and Utility Services. Each element includes three specific goals that support the overall vision. The Plan also outlines targeted strategies for achieving these goals, along with implementation steps and responsible parties.

Regional Technical Committee (RTC) — serves as an advisory unit, reporting directly to the DVRPC Board, about: (1) transportation planning initiatives, (2) the development and maintenance of the Transportation Improvement Program, (3) the development of the Long-Range Plan, (4) the development of the Unified Planning Work Program, and (5) all other transportation planning as directed by the Board.

Roadway System Expansion Projects — projects that involve adding new capacity to the existing roadway network, such as new roads, new through lanes, or major realignments that increase overall system capacity. These projects are checked for consistency with the CMP and included in air quality conformity analysis.

State of Good Repair (SGR) — infrastructure elements (roads, bridges, rail tracks, stations, transit revenue vehicles) are maintained in a reliable, functional, and safe state.

- **NJDOT Definition** — life-cycle planning approach and investment strategies expressed in terms of the percentage of the assets in Good or Fair condition.
 - 80 percent of pavements on SHS roadways (by lane miles) are in a state of good repair (SGR).
 - 94 percent of NBIS bridges on SHS roadways (by deck area) are in an SGR.
 - 95 percent of NBIS bridges on NHS roadways (by deck area) are in an SGR.
- **PennDOT Definition** — no more than 5 percent of NHS Interstate and non-Interstate pavement lane miles shall be rated in poor condition (FHWA minimum); no more than 10 percent of total NHS bridge deck area shall be rated in poor condition (FHWA minimum). The current practice of prioritizing NHS assets over other networks.

Transportation Improvement Program (TIP) — a federally mandated, short-range program that lists all regionally

significant and federally funded transportation projects to be implemented in a metropolitan planning organization's (MPO) region. The TIP includes detailed information on project scopes, schedules, and funding sources, and must demonstrate fiscal constraint. It is developed through a cooperative process involving state DOTs, transit operators, local governments, and the public, and must align with the region's Long-Range Plan.

TIP Action — a formal amendment or administrative modification to the Transportation Improvement Program.

Urbanized Area (UA) — An area defined by the U.S. Census Bureau with a population of 50,000 or more, characterized by densely developed residential, commercial, and other urban land uses. In the context of FHWA and FTA funding, urbanized areas are used to determine how federal transportation funds are allocated. Different funding programs and planning

requirements may apply based on the size and characteristics of the urbanized area.

Unfunded, Aspirational Projects — projects that are not currently funded or programmed but are included in the Long-Range Plan as priorities that are consistent with its vision and goals, and could be funded if additional resources become available.

Year-of-Expenditure (Y-O-E) — a method of expressing estimated project costs in the actual dollars expected to be spent in the year the expenditure will occur, accounting for inflation and cost escalation over time (FHWA Financial Plans Guidance). Funded MRPs are expressed in YOE dollars, whereas 2025 base cost dollars are used to represent unfunded projects.

Acronyms

ACS	American Community Survey	EV	Electric Vehicle
ADA	Americans with Disabilities Act	FHWA	Federal Highway Administration
BIL	Bipartisan Infrastructure Law	FRA	Federal Railroad Administration
BRT	Bus Rapid Transit	FTA	Federal Transit Administration
BSL	Broad Street Line	FY	Fiscal Year
CBO	Congressional Budget Office	FFY	Federal Fiscal Year
CIG	Capital Investment Grant	GIS	Geographic Information System
CJTF	Central Jersey Transportation Forum (of DVRPC)	GSI	Green Stormwater Infrastructure
CMAQ	Congestion Mitigation and Air Quality	HCTF	Healthy Communities Task Force
CMP	Congestion Management Process	HSIP	Highway Safety Improvement Program
COVID-19	Coronavirus Disease 2019	HTF	Highway Trust Fund
CPT	Collaborative Planning Theory	HVAC	Heating, Ventilation, and Air Conditioning
DOT	Department of Transportation	ICM	Integrated Corridor Management
DRJTBC	Delaware River Joint Toll Bridge Commission	IIJA	Infrastructure Investment and Jobs Act
DVRPC	Delaware Valley Regional Planning Commission	IMP	Interstate Management Program
ECG	East Coast Greenway	ISTEA	Intermodal Surface Transportation Efficiency Act

KSI	Killed or Suspected of being Seriously Injured	NTPSP	National Transit Public Safety Plan
LEP	Limited English Proficiency	PA	Pennsylvania
LLCC	Lowest Life-Cycle Cost	PAMS	Pavement Asset Management System
LOTTR	Level of Travel Time Reliability	PennDOT	Pennsylvania Department of Transportation
LTS	Level of Traffic Stress	PHED	Peak Hours of Excessive Delay
MP	Milepost	PHL	Philadelphia International Airport
MPO	Metropolitan Planning Organization	PTC	Pennsylvania Turnpike Commission
MRP	Major Regional Project	PTI	Planning Time Index
NAICS	North American Industry Classification System	ROW	Right-of-Way
NECC	Northeast Corridor Commission	SEPTA	Southeastern Pennsylvania Transit Authority
NETS	National Establishment Time Series	SJPC	South Jersey Port Corporation
NHFP	National Highway Freight Program	SJTA	South Jersey Transportation Authority
NHFN	National Highway Freight Network	SOV	Single-Occupancy Vehicle
NJ	New Jersey	SPT	Safety Performance Target
NJDOT	New Jersey Department of Transportation	SRPRA	Schuylkill River Passenger Rail Authority
NJTA	New Jersey Turnpike Authority	STIP	Statewide Transportation Improvement Program
NTD	National Transit Database	TAMP	Transit Asset Management Plan

TASP	Transit Agency Safety Plan	ULB	Useful Life Benchmark
TCM	Transportation Control Measure	UZA	Urbanized Area
TERM	FTA Transit Economic Requirements Model	USDOT	United States Department of Transportation
TIFIA	Transportation Infrastructure Finance and Innovation Act	VMT	Vehicle Miles Traveled
		VRM	Vehicle Revenue Miles
TIM	Traffic Incident Management	RVZ	Regional Vision Zero
TIP	Transportation Improvement Program	YOE	Year-of-Expenditure
TMA	Transportation Management Association		
TPK	Turnpike		
TOD	Transit-Oriented Development		
TPM	Transportation Performance Management		
TRID	Transit Revitalization Investment District		
TSMO	Transportation Systems Management and Operations		
TTF	Transportation Trust Fund		
TTI	Travel Time Index		
TTTR	Truck Travel Time Reliability		
TYP	Twelve-Year Program		